



10 medals (five gold, two silver, and three bronze). Meanwhile, South Korea (three gold, three silver) displaced the United States of America (one gold, three silver, one bronze) from the second spot.

There were other highlights from the Olympic campaign that suggest that a true watershed moment for Indian shooting may not be far. In fact, it could be a little over three years and around 9,000 km away (the distance between Paris and Los Angeles).

Manu herself came painstakingly close to another bronze medal in the 25m sports pistol. When the curtains fell on 'Rapid' in the qualification round, only Veronika Major of Hungary had a better score than

Manu. And it was Major again, who trumped the Indian in a shoot-off for bronze in the final by registering an extra hit (10.2-plus shot).

Arjun Babuta also missed out on a podium finish after shooting a rare 9.5 in his final attempt on target. Croatia's Miran Maricic, who eventually won the bronze medal, was only 0.2 ahead of Babuta until the deciding shot was fired.

Another fourth-place finish came back to haunt the Indian contingent, albeit this time in the shotgun arena. In the skeet mixed team bronze medal match, the Chinese duo of Jiang Yiting and Lyu Jianlin pipped Anant Jeet Singh Naruka and Maheshwari Chauhan 44-43, with Jianlin registering a perfect series!

Heartbreak: Arjun Babuta narrowly missed out on a medal, finishing fourth in the men's air rifle final at the Paris Olympics, after remaining in contention for a podium spot throughout the competition.

RITU RAJ KONWAR

The party continues in Paris...

The Olympic success was reflected in India's Paralympic campaign as well, where Avani Lekhara became the first Indian woman to win two gold medals at the Games, defending her title in the women's 10m air rifle standing SH1 shooting event with a world record score. Mona Agarwal won a bronze in the same discipline.